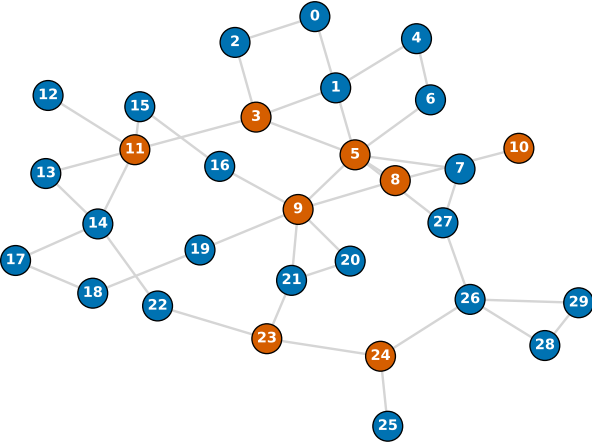
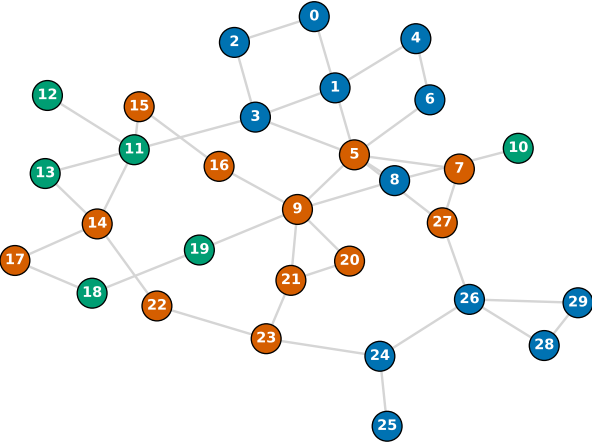


Figure 3 -- Nested dissection unfolded. Each level splits every block at its electrically weakest cut; the red buses are the separators whose removal makes the two halves conditionally independent.

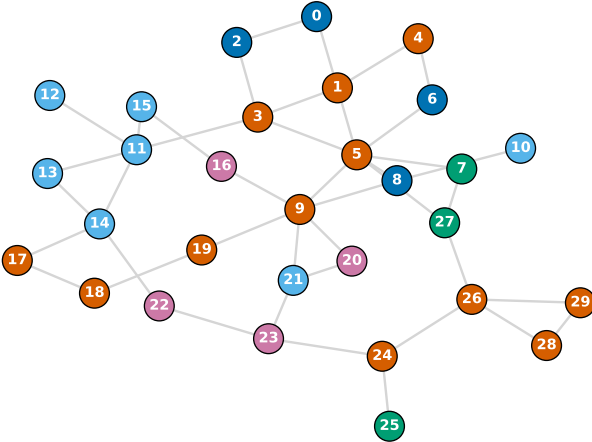
level 0: 1 block(s), 8 separator bus(es) in red



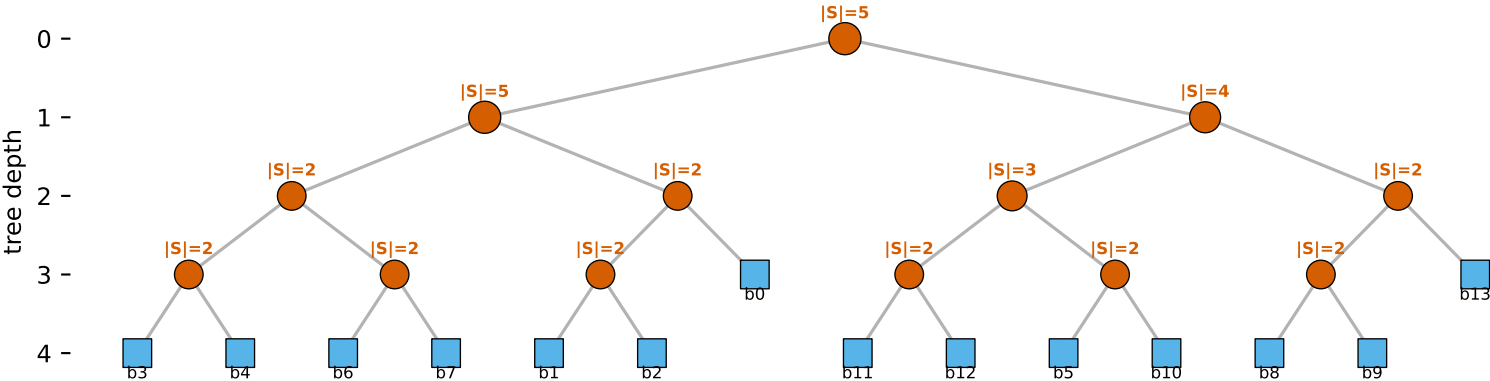
level 1: 2 block(s), 12 separator bus(es) in red



level 2: 4 block(s), 12 separator bus(es) in red



(d) the resulting separator tree for case14 -- red = separator (internal node), cyan = bus (leaf)



(e) separators shrink as the recursion descends

